

Product Research Guide

Work through each section before finalizing a product for Amazon, Flipkart, or Meesho. Treat any two unchecked red-flag items as a reason to pause.

Demand Validation

- ☐ Category best-seller rank checked to gauge real sales volume
- ☐ Search volume for the core keyword confirmed as meaningful, not a niche guess
- ☐ Seasonality mapped — is demand year-round or festival-spike only
- ☐ Google Trends checked to confirm demand isn't declining
- ☐ Cross-marketplace demand compared (Amazon vs Flipkart vs Meesho)

Competition Analysis

- ☐ Number of active sellers/listings for this exact product counted
- ☐ Top 5 competitor listings reviewed for price, rating, and review count
- ☐ Gap identified — what are competitors doing poorly that you can fix
- ☐ Brand-dominated categories flagged as high-risk for new entrants
- ☐ Private label vs. commodity positioning decided

Profitability Check

- ☐ Landed cost calculated including GST, packaging and inward freight
- ☐ Platform commission and payment gateway fee factored in per marketplace
- ☐ Estimated ad spend (10-20% of revenue) included in margin math
- ☐ Return rate assumption built into the P&L for the category
 - Apparel and footwear typically run 15-35% returns — factor this in before pricing.*
- ☐ Target margin after all costs is at least 15-20% net

Sourcing & Compliance

- ☐ Reliable supplier identified with consistent quality and MOQ you can absorb
- ☐ Required certifications checked (BIS, FSSAI, etc. where applicable)
- ☐ HSN code and applicable GST slab confirmed
- ☐ Packaging and labelling requirements for the marketplace confirmed

Red Flags to Avoid

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- ☐ Category with heavy brand/patent restrictions
- ☐ Product with high damage/breakage risk in transit
- ☐ Category already saturated with 100+ near-identical listings under Rs.99
- ☐ Trending-only product with no sign of sustained demand
- ☐ Category with a history of frequent policy or compliance changes

A structured checklist for validating whether a product is worth listing before you commit inventory budget.